

Technology News



Firefox 3.5 twice as fast as Firefox 3 on complex websites

Mozilla has released Firefox 3.5, a major update to the popular Web browser. Coming one year after the launch of Firefox 3, version 3.5 introduces many new features, as well as new support for a wide variety of Web standards, the company says. Firefox 3.5 makes claims to being the best performing browser Mozilla has ever released and delivers radically improved JavaScript performance, a new Private Browsing mode, native support for open video and audio, and Location Aware Browsing. The newest version of Firefox is more than two times faster than Firefox 3, and 10 times faster than Firefox 2 on complex websites, the company claims.

Firefox 3.5 includes the new TraceMonkey JavaScript engine, which is supposed to deliver unprecedented performance with today's complex Web applications. It also delivers the first native integration of audio and video directly into the browser. Now everyone can easily watch open format Ogg Theora videos. Web developers can use these technologies to design pages that interact with video content in new and exciting ways, offering richer interactive experiences beyond controlling playback and volume. Meanwhile, location-aware browsing saves you time by allowing websites to ask you where you are located. If you choose to share your location with a website, it can use that information to find nearby points of interest and return additional, useful data like maps of your area. It's all optional—Firefox doesn't share your location without your permission.



TI OMAP3530 reference board includes Linux support

L&T Infotech has announced the availability of the TI OMAP3530-based reference platform in Linux and Android flavours. The custom TI OMAP3530 reference board is targeted at OEMs developing products such as mobile TV solutions, portable media players (PMP), personal navigation devices (PND), mobile Internet devices (MID) and portable gaming devices. It allows OEMs to prototype and validate their innovative product designs across various mobile operating systems.

The TI OMAP3530 application processor includes ARM Cortex-A8 operating at a maximum speed of 600MHz, and C64x+ DSP operating at a maximum speed of 430MHz. The reference platform's features include a 4.3" (10.9 cm) TFT LCD touchscreen (480 x 272 QVGA), 128 MB DDR II memory, 256 MB Nand Flash, a 1.8" (4.6 cm) CE-ATA hard disk, a VGA camera, a DVB-H receiver, a GPS module, an FM tuner, a USB 2.0 Host and OTG support, connectivity (Wi-Fi, Bluetooth), speakers, a microphone and headset, and a 3 x 3 matrix keypad. It also has a microSD slot, which can be used for WiMAX connectivity required for MID functionality. It can be battery-operated with a 3.7V, 1AH Li-on battery and provides a close-to-product form factor, which comes very handy for the development community to enable easy demonstration of their applications on the hardware. The TI OMAP3530 reference platform includes support for Linux, WinCE 6.0 and Android 1.1 Board Support Package (BSP).



VLC is now Goldeneye

Well, that's what version 1.0.0 of the popular media player is code-named. The release includes frame-by-frame playback, on-the-fly recording and finer speed control during playback. Besides improvements



to Real Media playback and TS demultiplexer for M2TS files from Blu-ray and AVCHD (in addition to fixes to 5.1 and 7.1 channel decoding and ordering), the new version includes the following new decoders: AES3, Dolby Digital Plus, True HD/MLP and Blu-ray Linear PCM decoders.

A completely updated stack with Pardus 2009

Whether you want to run OpenOffice.org 3.1, Firefox 3.5.1 or kernel 2.6.30, Pardus 2009 packs all these in one. What's more, the release now officially features KDE4 (version 4.2.4). Version 2009 contains many bug fixes and enhancements, including improved hardware support, latest releases of Pardus Manager tools, an up-to-date software repository,

performance improvements all over the system, etc. Pardus 2009 has also been improved graphically in every part of the distribution. All

the splash systems, from bootloader to login screen, have been revised. Also, Pardus' icon theme, Milky, has been introduced to users.